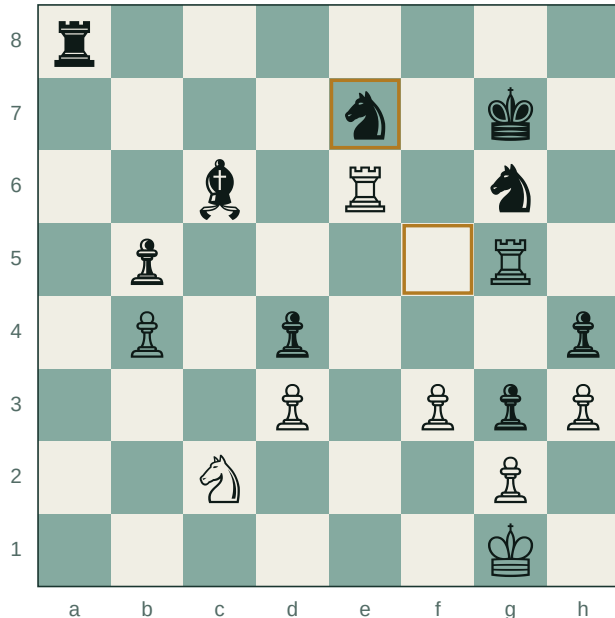


# Skewers: White, move 41

Skewers

White to move



Previous move: 40...Ne7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**41. Rxe7+ Kf6 42. Rxg6+ Kxe7 43. Rxc6 Kd7 44. Rc5**

**41.Rxe7+** Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the knight on e7. Recorded reply: **41...Kf6**.

**42.Rxg6+** Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the knight on g6. Recorded reply: **42...Kxe7**.

**43.Rxc6** The rook captures the bishop on c6. Recorded reply: **43...Kd7**.

**44.Rc5** The rook moves from c6 to c5.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from +0 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A skewer puts the more important target in front. When that target moves, a piece behind it may be lost. Checks make the geometry especially forcing.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on g7. Absolute pin: knight on g6.